Diagnosis: quote-to-order handoff

@Yoad · Riverside Insights GTM Engineer take-home · Synthetic data, as of Feb 10, 2026

The root issue

Closed Won is the signal to start an order, but nothing checks that the deal is complete when a rep marks it won. The facts Deal Operations needs are split between CRM fields and the rep's free-text note, and the two often disagree.

4 of the 5 Closed Won deals had at least one handoff issue: $246,000 of $294,500 (84%) of sample value. OPP-002 has a pending approval, and its note says 18% while the quote shows 25%. OPP-004 has no billing entity and an expired quote. OPP-005 has two identical orders. OPP-006's note names a kit that isn't on the order. And OPP-003's note asks ops to start work on a deal that isn't signed.

Priorities and scope

1. **Block** deals missing what an order needs: approval, a valid quote, a billing entity, a start date.
2. **Review** duplicate orders and notes that contradict the fields. A person decides.
3. **Warn** on buying signals and stale contacts, like Pine Ridge's RFP posted after close. These never hold up a handoff.

Out of scope: CRM and order-system integration, signal scoring, enrichment vendors, discount policy and invoicing.

Assumption to validate

With Deal Operations: an order can't be built on an expired quote, even when the customer signed before it expired (OPP-004). If Deal Ops can honor the signed price, that check becomes a warning.

Stakeholders and discovery questions

Deal Operations, Sales and Finance.

1. What makes a deal Closed Won: a signed contract or a received purchase order?

2. How long does Closed Won to a correct order take today, and where does the time go?
3. How do duplicate orders happen, and are split orders ever intended?
4. Who can approve a discount, and where is that approval recorded?
5. What do reps put in the note instead of a field, and why?

Fix	Impact	Effort	Risk
Required fields before a deal can be Closed Won (HubSpot rule)	High	Low	Low
Pre-handoff check with a review queue (what I built)	High	Medium	Medium: more reviews at first
AI reading of notes, every fact quoted	Medium	Low	Medium: misreads only reach review

Measurement and data quality

Baseline assumption: about 4 in 5 won deals reach Deal Ops with an issue. A two-week pilot baseline confirms or corrects that. **Before/after metric:** the share of Closed Won deals that are Ready on the first check, 1 of 5 (20%) in this sample.

Directory issue: every contact is a district-level role filed under one school, deals and the directory share no district ID, and 2 of the 6 districts are missing. **Refresh rule:** re-verify a contact when it's over 12 months old, right away when a leadership-change signal arrives, and for every district each school year. Add a district ID to every deal.